P0: Project Pitch

Overview

You will create a video pitch for a project you would like to create over the course of the Capstone. This pitch will include a summary the project concept, illustrate the project proposed, comparisons to similar works, and demonstrations for unique concepts that would be developed if the pitch is approved.

Specification

The pitch should meet the following requirements. Consider the pitch a proposed contract for development (in terms of scope of work)!

Structure

The pitch should be 45-60 seconds long and should be delivered as an unlisted YouTube video.

Presentation

The presentation should be audibly narrated (non-human voices are not allowed) and have supporting video describing the project and pitch elements (visuals should be illustrative in nature, not merely decorative). There may be background audio, but it should not overpower the narration. The video is expected to be edited, but audio may not be artificially sped-up (i.e., "chipmunk style").

The pitch should present platforms with comparable features or use cases. The presentation (i.e. narration) should describe the relevance of the comparable elements and describe how they apply to the pitch in question.

Finally, the video presentation should include visual and/or audio demonstrations of exceptional aspects of the project (such as unique interface or application of technology) where applicable for the purpose of further illustration.

Pitch Concept

Each pitch should contain, at a minimum, the following elements:

1. **One-Line (Elevator) Pitch:** A single sentence that summarizes the project concept and what makes it unique.
2. **Working Name:** Working title for the project (which may be changed later)
3. **Audience:** Description and justification for the project's target user group
4. **Use-Case Story:** Description of the "story" concept for the proposed project (e.g., an example use-case)

5. **Core Features:** Explanation of features fundamental to the project's primary function
6. **Technology Platforms:** Description of the target platform (FPGA, mobile, PC, custom, other) and principal technologies involved.
7. **Aesthetic Theme:** Description of the key aesthetic elements of the project (***includes hardware projects!***). It is often helpful to illustrate aesthetics visually.
    - *Note:* "Clean" is **not** an aesthetic! No one enjoys "dirty" aesthetics.

Pitch Summary

The pitch should end with an overall summary of the project concept. The submitter should seek to describe how the project elements come together to create a compelling argument for the project's development.

Banned Project Concepts

We've found, after many administrations of this and other courses, that certain concepts come up over and over with little to no novelty to them. Because of this, as a general rule, the following concepts are not accepted unless they are found to be novel by course instructors:

1. Plant watering devices
2. Pet toy devices
3. Weather tracking devices

Submissions

You will submit a YouTube URL for their unlisted pitch video on Canvas.

Draft Pitch Review Session (10% of Grade)

You will meet with a TA to briefly (~5 mins) discuss your project pitch concept and your presentation **before** the pitch due date.

The aim is to reduce overlap in projects and give you an opportunity to refine your pitch for both the purposes of scoring and projects to be worked on.

Pitch Q&A

1. **Q:** What if my idea is terrible? Will I get a bad grade if my project doesn't get greenlit?

   A: It probably isn't, but we don't grade based on whether your project gets the greenlight – we apply the rubric.

2. **Q:** Do I really have to include the Comparables/Summary/X?

   A: Yes. If we list it as a requirement, it needs to be done.

3. **Q:** But X is pointless! Why do I have to do it?

   A: We know it may be obvious to you – it's your idea! Treat us like we're dumb. Sometimes we are. 😊

4. **Q:** Why do I have to do my pitch in 60 seconds? There isn't enough time to say what I want!

   A: Concision is hard – but it's important. Learning to work with boundaries to present information is critical.

5. **Q:** Why do I have to do this? I hate presenting!

   A: It's a skill you'll need in industry and academia. Also, our accreditation requires us to assess it.

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   A: It's a skill you'll need in industry and academia. Also, our accreditation requires us to assess it.